Iain Andrew

Senior Software Engineer

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Summary

Senior software engineer, twelve years on the web: frontend by trade and full stack in practice (TypeScript, React and Next.js; Ruby on Rails, React Native, Cloudflare Workers). The last five and a half years at Canva (Pexels), a stock photo and video platform with roughly a million visitors a day. Led the 2025 programme that roughly tripled monthly sign-ups to Canva from Pexels, every change run as a controlled experiment. Plans, decomposes and reviews by hand; coding agents write most of the code, every output verified. Available now for a remote senior or staff software engineering role.

Experience

Senior Software Engineer, Canva (Pexels) – Remote, Dublin Apr 2021 – Nov 2026

Canva's free stock photo and video platform: a website in 28 locales, iOS and Android apps, a public API and a contributor community. Frontend engineer, then from 2025 the engineer accountable for initiatives end to end across web, backend, mobile and data.

- Led the 2025 programme moving Pexels users into Canva's editor, ten initiatives from scoping to readout: daily click-throughs to Canva up roughly 79%, monthly sign-ups to Canva roughly tripled.
- Shipped a dual Download / Edit in Canva button on every grid tile after a three-way A/B test: a 45% lift in daily click-throughs to Canva from a single launch.
- Built the in-house A/B testing platform when Google Optimize was retired (Cloudflare Worker assignment, per-variant caching, Snowplow events); every web experiment since late 2023 runs on it.
- Redesigned consumer onboarding around an intent-aware auth modal that completes the triggering action after sign-in: 11 steps to like a photo as a new user became 3.
- Led and built most of The Level Up, Pexels' first photography course: Rails models and API, a video player with captions in 28 locales, a Python Whisper caption pipeline; delegated two workstreams.
- Cut peak deploy response time 71% (4.6s to 1.3s) with readiness checks and route pre-warming on the Next.js fleet; earlier restructured the fleet after load testing, memory per process down 65%.
- Found that account-deletion emails had carried a full API bearer token since 2022; replaced it across backend, web and mobile with a throttled single-use code and removed a CSRF-exposed endpoint.
- Owned the frontend of the EU Digital Services Act content-reporting flow (report form, appeals, in-review state), built in under a week once designs settled and shipped on the regulatory deadline.
- Built reporting and moderation for community posts and comments across web, backend and mobile in three weeks: soft deletion, member reporting, a staff moderation queue, all locales.
- Made AI tooling a team capability: the write-up that opened the team's adoption, weekly sessions, an AGENTS.md configuration adopted across Pexels repositories; coached the designer to his first PR.

Lead Front End Engineer, Wia – Dublin Mar 2018 – Mar 2021

Internet of Things platform startup. Sole frontend engineer for three years, owning the Angular web application from architecture to release.

- Built a drag-and-drop code editor on Google Blockly so beginners could program IoT devices: custom blocks generating Arduino code in real time, compiled and deployed from the browser.
- Built the occupancy analytics dashboard (Angular, amCharts) and Space Designer, where users upload a floor plan and draw the zones to measure on an HTML canvas.

Front End Web Developer, USIT – Dublin Apr 2015 – Mar 2018

Ireland's student travel and work-abroad company. In-house frontend developer for its public sites, campaign pages and booking journeys.

- Designed and built the page template behind hundreds of adventure-tour packages, with an interactive itinerary map on Mapbox GL and programmatic Vimeo header video.

Web Developer and Designer, Freelance – Dublin Jun 2014 – Apr 2015

- Web development, UI design and branding for a range of clients, after a developer and designer internship at Plugmedia (front-end UI, branding, Joomla, PHP).

Audio Engineer and Producer, Freelance, then Aria Mastering – Dublin Jan 2011 – Mar 2014

- Audio engineer and music producer in Dublin recording studios, then ran an online mastering business from a home studio.

Skills

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript (Node.js), Ruby (Rails), Python (media pipelines), HTML, CSS, SCSS

Frontend: React, Next.js (SSR, hydration, server-side experiments, edge caching), react-query, Storybook, Framer Motion, CSS architecture (cascade layers, custom-property theming)

Mobile and backend: React Native (Expo), App Store and Play Store releases, Ruby on Rails (models, migrations, serializers, background jobs), PostgreSQL, Braze

Data and experimentation: A/B testing platform design, guard-rail metrics, experiment readouts, Snowplow and Iglu schemas, Zod, Snowflake, Mode dashboards

Platform and quality: Cloudflare Workers, Kubernetes, k6 load testing, Jest, React Testing Library, Sentry, AppSignal, Datadog, Smartling localisation (28 locales)

Workflow: AI-assisted development (Cursor, Claude Code, Codex), MCP servers (Jira, GitHub, device automation), AGENTS.md and SKILL.md agent configuration, spec-first builds, review of generated code

Delivery: End-to-end ownership of cross-functional programmes (scoping to readout), estimation, delegation, technical writing (design docs, runbooks, post-incident reviews), mentoring, on-call

Education

Sound Training Centre, Diploma in Sound Engineering and Music Production 2010 – 2012